



CLEAN ENERGY CONFERENCE AFRICA AUSTRALIA

Powering the future

CONFERENCE & EXHIBITION PROGRAMME



31ST AUG - 1ST SEPT 2026
NOVOTEL HOTEL, PERTH,
WESTERN AUSTRALIA





The global transition towards clean energy, advanced technologies, and electric mobility is driving unprecedented demand for components that underpin modern industrial and renewable energy systems. As countries accelerate efforts to achieve net-zero carbon emissions, various elements have become essential components of the global energy and technology supply chain.

Africa is emerging as a strategic partner in meeting this demand, given its vast potential and growing role within the global green and digital economy. Within this evolving landscape, Kenya is positioning itself as an emerging and competitive destination for responsible clean energy investment, supported by progressive policy reforms, improved data, and a strong commitment to sustainable and transparent resource development.

Australia Africa and Mineral institute AAEMI, The Ministry of infrastructure in Rwanda, Minister of Energy in Kenya, Minister of Environment Kenya, United Nation Human Resources and Entire African Government Ministries and agencies, is implementing a deliberate strategy to unlock the Clean Energy potential and integrate Africa more competitively into the global value chain. As part of this Africa/Australia agenda, AAEMI has convened the Clean Energy Conference Africa Australia (CEC) 2026 for the last 9 years

The conference serves as Africa premier mining investment platform, bringing together policymakers, global investors, mining companies, financial institutions, development partners, technology providers, and mining communities to explore opportunities within the country's rapidly evolving mineral sector.

More than a traditional conference, CEC 2026 is designed as a strategic investment marketplace where business presents viable opportunities, investors engage directly with project developers and regulators, and stakeholders forge partnerships that support the sustainable growth .

The event has convened over 700 delegates from across Africa and the global Energy ecosystem, creating a credible platform for investment dialogue, partnership development, and collaboration across the entire mineral value chain.



Welcome Note

Chairman of Clean Energy Conference and Kenya Australia Chamber of Commerce



Stephen Kuria

Executive Chairman, Australia
Kenya Chamber of Commerce

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Our focus is to translate this opportunity into tangible investment outcomes through progressive sustainable practices and strategic partnerships

It gives me great pleasure to welcome you to the Clean Energy Conference Australia Africa 2026. As global demand for clean energy accelerates, driven by the transition to clean energy and advanced technologies, Africa is positioning itself as a competitive and responsible destination for investment.

Our focus is to translate this opportunity into tangible investment outcomes through progressive sustainable practices and strategic partnerships. African resources as a catalyst for Energy and economic transformation, industrial growth, and sustainable development.

Central to this vision is the advancement of value addition, ensuring that our resources generate greater in-country value, create quality jobs, and drive inclusive prosperity.



Conference Objective

Showcase Viable Clean Energy Opportunities:

Provide a platform for government and project developers to present bankable renewable energy projects—including solar, wind, geothermal, and green hydrogen—and investment opportunities to local and international investors across the continent.

Facilitate Direct Investor Engagement:

Enable investors to engage directly with regulators, project developers, and industry stakeholders through structured networking and deal-making sessions to accelerate project financing and cross-border collaboration.

Strengthen Strategic Partnerships:

Align national energy priorities with development partners, financial institutions, and private sector actors to mobilize capital, technology, and expertise for the expansion of Africa's green energy infrastructure.

Advance Sustainable and Responsible Energy Development:

Promote environmental, social, and governance (ESG) practices that ensure energy projects contribute positively to local communities, support regional grid stability, and align with Africa's climate resilience and net-zero goals.

Promote Local Manufacturing and Regional Energy Value Chains:

Encourage investment in local manufacturing of renewable energy components, e-mobility solutions, and energy storage technologies, leveraging AfCFTA frameworks to increase employment, strengthen intra-African industrial linkages, and reduce reliance on energy imports.

Facilitate Knowledge Exchange and Innovation:

Provide a platform for sharing best practices in cross-border grid integration, regional energy pooling, digitalization, and policy harmonization that support the long-term, sustainable growth of the African clean energy market.

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Conference Structure

The conference will feature a dynamic program designed to facilitate high-level dialogue, knowledge exchange, and investment engagement. Key components include:



Target Audience and Reach

The conference aims to convene 500-700 delegates representing the full spectrum of the global mining and investment ecosystem, including:



Investors

Local, regional, and international investors seeking opportunities in the clean energy sector



Multinational Clean Energy corporations

Operating across the global clean energy markets



Financial institutions

Including development finance institutions and commercial banks



Government officials

From national and county governments responsible clean energy and investment policy



Development partners

Supporting sustainable economic growth and natural resource governance.



Industry associations

And business organizations representing private sector interests



Equipment manufacturers

And technology providers showcasing innovations for the sector.



Academia and research institutions

Presenting technical insights and knowledge



Industry experts and consultants

Including economists, analysts, and legal specialists.



Media organizations

providing national and international coverage of the sector.

AUSTRALIA EDITION

31ST AUG - 1ST SEPT 2026
NOVOTEL HOTEL, PERTH,
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

DAY ONE : Monday, 31st August, 2026

8:00 – 8:45 a.m. Registration and Welcome Refreshments.
Opening

Mcs - Peter Grant
Nkandu Beltz

8:45 – 9:00 a.m. Opening Remarks
Mr. Stephen Kuria, MD, AAEMI

9:00 – 10:00 a.m. **SESSION 1**

Opening Address

» Hon. Ayor Makur Chuot MLC, Western Australia
The Member for North Metropolitan,

» Mr. Edmund Damouni, Honorary Consul in Western
Australia

*Topic: Powering Regional Growth: Strengthening Morocco-Australia
Energy Diplomacy for a Resilient and Integrated Clean Energy Future*

» H.E. Wilson Kogo, High Commissioner

PANELISTS

- Dr. Rose Mwebaza, UNEP
- Hon. Dan Van Holst Pellekaan (TBC)

Opening Keynote Address

Geopolitics & Energy Diplomacy- Developments, supply chain realignments, Power infrastructures and changing global energy landscape- the macroeconomic forces influencing African energy

Fireside Chat

Global trade and geopolitics have continued to evolve affecting investor and political perception of exploration. With the U.S. Administration focused on the promise of cheaper, reliable and secure energy and a sudden shift across much of the west from a rapid energy "transition" to more rational energy policies, will calls for increased supply support or challenge exploration in Africa? The panel aims to explore the impact of these shifts on exploration and capital investment in Africa, where E&P companies have expanded interest in frontier areas and the fundamental need for energy access remain paramount.

Mc
Nkandu Beltz

SESSION 2

The Australian Energy Crossroads: A Bridge or a Barrier?

Australia stands at a pivotal junction, balancing its role as a global energy powerhouse with the urgent necessity of a sustainable future. As we navigate the dual mandates of energy security and ambitious climate targets, the debate over the role of natural gas has never been more volatile or more vital.

Is natural gas the pragmatic foundation for Australia's energy reliability, or are we clinging to an infrastructure that compromises our commitment to a cleaner future?

Today, we bring together leading policymakers, technical innovators, and financial experts to strip away the rhetoric. We are here to challenge the status quo and interrogate the trade-offs:

How do we reconcile the immediate demand for affordable, dispatchable energy with the imperative of rapid decarbonization?

Are our current financial and regulatory frameworks accelerating the transition, or are they inadvertently locking us into long-term climate risk?

Can natural gas truly act as a catalyst for cleaner energy adoption, or is it merely slowing the momentum toward renewables?

The floor is open for a rigorous, no-holds-barred debate. Let's confront the complexities of Australia's energy landscape and define what "optimal" really means for our national development.

PANELISTS

- Shohan Seneviratne- CEO, Murchison Green Hydrogen
- David Cavanagh- Hydrogen Expert
- Mr. Gavin Rainbow - The Founder & Principal Consultant, Auctalise Group.
- Representative, Institution of Energy

11:30 -12:30 p.m.

SESSION 3

Investment, Regulation, Financing Transition

Global energy transition requires unprecedented levels of capital, yet the path for investors remains cluttered with red tape, shifting regulatory sands, and structural uncertainty. While G20 nations and emerging economies hold the keys to a cleaner future, the persistent friction in our investment frameworks is stalling progress when we need speed the most.

Are we genuinely committed to de-risking the energy transition, or are we trapped by the very bureaucratic hurdles and legal inconsistencies that keep capital on the sidelines?

Today, we bring together the architects of global finance and policy to move beyond the usual platitudes. We are here to confront the reality of why, despite the massive global appetite for sustainable projects, investment continues to be stifled.

Which regulatory roadblocks are truly obsolete, and why do they persist in the face of our climate goals?

Is it a lack of capital, or a lack of courage in reform that is preventing the surge of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) into our most critical markets?

How do we harmonize legal frameworks across borders to move from disjointed, risk-averse initiatives to a truly global, efficient energy market?

PRESENTATION

- Peter Grant- Energy Advisor International Energy Solutions Pty Ltd

PANELISTS

- Dr. Christopher Lagat- director of learning , Curtin University, WA
- Peter Grant- Energy Advisor International Energy Solutions Pty Ltd
- Mr. John Sutton - Energy Finance Specialist

12.30-13.20 p.m.

Lunch and Sponsor Showcase

13:30 -14:30 p.m.

SESSION 4

Geothermal, CCUS, Financing

We are at a critical juncture in the global energy transition. We're banking on the earth's heat, betting on carbon capture, and scrambling to find the trillions needed to fund it all. But as the clock ticks toward 2030, we have to move past the glossy brochures and get honest about the risks we're taking.

This panel isn't just about sharing updates; it's about testing our resolve. We'll be dismantling the following tensions:

The Geothermal Gamble: We're eyeing next-generation geothermal to provide constant, clean power. But are we ready to scale industrial-grade drilling and hybrid systems without repeating the environmental mistakes of the past?

The CCUS Conundrum: Carbon Capture, Utilization, and Storage is being hailed as the lifeline for oil, gas, and mining. Is this the pragmatic bridge to a net-zero future, or is it a convenient excuse to keep the carbon-heavy status quo on life support?

The Financing Chasm: The capital exists, but the "risk" doesn't disappear just because it's labeled green. With renewable projects struggling to secure bankable models, are we creating genuine risk-sharing partnerships, or just shifting the burden onto the next generation?

PANELISTS

- Mireille Toulekina- Non-Executive Director, MT Energy Resources
- EPRA Representative - TBA
- Harrison Keter

From Waste to Resource:

Sustainable Recycling of Lithium-Ion Batteries for a Circular Clean Energy Future

- Asad Ali
PhD Scholar (Chemical Engineering)
School of Engineering | Edith Cowan University

14:30 - 15:30 p.m.

SESSION 5

Energy Sovereignty, Grid, Workforce, Digital Infrastructure

Australia is at a defining juncture. We have the world-class natural resources to become a renewable energy superpower, yet we find ourselves caught in a “trilemma”: racing to build a resilient, decarbonized grid while grappling with the vulnerabilities of a digital-first energy system and a stalling pipeline of large-scale investment.

Are we truly building a sovereign, future-proof energy system, or are we simply swapping one form of dependence for another?

As we shift from ageing coal to a decentralized, electrified future, the stakes have shifted from mere capacity to the very integrity of our infrastructure—digital, physical, and financial. Today's panel cuts through the policy noise to address the hard questions:

Digital Sovereignty: In an era of AI-driven demand and global cyber threats, can Australia build energy systems that are truly secure and self-reliant, or are we structurally tethered to opaque global technology supply chains?

The Powerhouse Paradox: We have the wind and sun, but is our current grid architecture—and our progress in training the next-generation workforce—actually capable of handling the speed of this transition, or is our “powerhouse” ambition currently outpacing our engineering reality?

The Investment Gap: Billions in capital are waiting on the sidelines while developers face connection queues, planning bottlenecks, and grid congestion. Is the market currently optimized to attract the long-term capital we need, or are we failing to provide the certainty investors demand?

The panel is set, and the mandate is clear: let's move beyond the rhetoric of “clean energy” and interrogate the structural, digital, and financial systems that will determine if Australia leads or lags in the global energy race.

PANELISTS

- Prof Samuel Makinda-
Emeritus Professor in the
College of Law, Arts and
Social Sciences Murdoch
University
- Adrian De Merwe- Energy
& Resources

15:30 – 16:30 p.m.

SESSION 6

Energy Efficiency, Demand-Side, Community Scale

PANELISTS

For too long, energy efficiency has been viewed as a dry, technical box to tick—a matter of insulation ratings and appliance labels. It is time to flip the script: Efficiency is not just a technical challenge; it is Australia's most significant, and most ignored, economic opportunity.

Are we genuinely empowering Australian households to become active, rewarded managers of our energy future, or are we simply asking them to bear the cost of an aging, inefficient system?

Today, we move beyond the jargon to demand accountability. We are bringing together the visionaries and the implementers to confront the gap between our potential and our performance:

The Demand-Side Reality: Are our current demand-side management programs actually delivering relief to household budgets, or are they failing to gain the public trust required for mass adoption?

The Community Scale-Up: Why do high-impact, community-based efficiency projects remain localized success stories while our national energy strategy struggles to scale these models effectively?

The Prosperity Gap: If energy saved is truly energy earned, why haven't we treated efficiency as a primary resource, equal in priority to generation?

The panel is set to challenge the status quo. We are here to debate the policies and practical initiatives that will move us from passive consumption to active, grid-stabilizing prosperity.

- Mr. Warner Priest-
InterContinental Energy
- Pierre De Villier - Head
of Operational Risk
Assurance- Vantris energy
founding council member
of the Global Psychosocial
Safety Network Member
of the board of subsea
Energy Australia

SESSION 7

Energy Efficiency, Demand-Side, Community Scale

The question of whether Australia can “remove” community-integrated data centers is complex, as it pits the necessity of digital infrastructure against the strain on our national energy grid. While removing them entirely is economically and technologically unfeasible—given their status as the backbone of our digital economy—the current debate is focused on relocating, regulating, and revolutionizing how they operate.

Can We Remove Them?

“Removing” data centers from communities is currently being framed by policy experts and community groups not as an abolition, but as a de-clustering strategy. The primary issue is the current concentration of hyperscale facilities in urban areas, which creates “localized grid exposure,” straining substations and competing for water and power with local residents.

The Case for Decentralization: Shifting smaller or non-latency-critical workloads to regional areas—where land is abundant and renewable energy can be generated on-site—is increasingly viewed as a viable alternative to the “Sydney-centric” model.

The Constraints: High-speed fibre connectivity and the need for proximity to a skilled technical workforce mean that complete removal from urban hubs is impractical for many latency-sensitive AI applications.

How to Supply Power Needs

If the goal is to sustain these facilities without cannibalizing the energy required for homes and businesses, the focus is shifting toward “co-location” and “dedicated capacity”:

Renewable Energy “Additionality”: Policymakers and critics are pushing for data centers to move beyond simple offsets. True sustainability requires “additional” renewable generation—meaning data centers must fund and build new wind, solar, and battery storage projects that wouldn’t have existed otherwise, rather than just buying existing green power.

Off-Grid and Microgrid Integration: For regional centers, there is growing potential for dedicated renewable microgrids. By pairing data centers directly with large-scale solar or wind farms, operators can bypass some grid congestion and operate more independently.

Demand Response and Flexibility:

Health in Energy and Extractives industry

Powering the Future without burning out the people who build it. Key message: The energy transition cannot be sustainable if the workforce is not sustainable.

PANELISTS

- Mr. Stephen Kuria, MD, AAEMI
- Peter Grant- Energy Advisor International Energy Solutions Pty Ltd
- Brian Mureithi, EPRA TBC
- Kihara Muigai - TBC

- Charity Health you center

16.30 p.m.

Evening Tea and Networking



KIGALI EDITION

6TH - 7TH AUG 2026
THE KIGALI MARRIOTT HOTEL,
RWANDA

Welcome Note

Minister welcome and endorsement



Hon. James Opiyo Wanda, E.G.H
CS Energy and Petroleum, Kenya

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The Clean Energy Conference Africa Australia is a premier platform for driving investment, policy alignment, and technical innovation across our regions

The Clean Energy Conference Australia Africa is proud to announce that the Cabinet Secretary for the Ministry of Energy and Petroleum of the Republic of Kenya has officially confirmed their attendance at the upcoming Kigali, Rwanda edition.

In a major development for the August 2026 event, the Cabinet Secretary will deliver the keynote address, highlighting the vital role of cross-continental collaboration in the energy sector.

“We are honored to have the Ministry of Energy and Petroleum’s leadership on our stage,” said the event organizers. “This confirmation reinforces the strategic importance of the Clean Energy Conference Australia Africa as a premier platform for driving investment, policy alignment, and technical innovation across our regions.”

Following the confirmation, the Ministry has initiated formal planning with the Secretary for Renewable Energy to coordinate the participation of Kenya’s broader energy sector delegation. Furthermore, the Ministry will host a pre-conference briefing to discuss key leverage opportunities for Kenya, ensuring that the delegation is prepared to maximize the impact of their engagement.

The Kigali edition of the Clean Energy Conference Australia Africa will take place on 6–7 August, 2026, bringing together industry leaders, policymakers, and innovators to accelerate the transition to sustainable energy

Welcome Note

Minister welcome and endorsement



Hon. Armand Zingiro

Minister of State

Minister of State in the Ministry of Infrastructure

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This initiative aligns well with Rwanda's national priorities on clean energy transition, climate resilience, and sustainable development

The Ministry of Infrastructure (MININFRA) of the Republic of Rwanda has officially expressed its support for the upcoming Clean Energy Conference 2026, scheduled to take place from 6–7 August 2026.

“This initiative aligns well with Rwanda's national priorities on clean energy transition, climate resilience, and sustainable development.” — MININFRA.

The Ministry highlighted the importance of the conference as a strategic platform for fostering dialogue, strengthening international partnerships, and accelerating investments in vital clean energy solutions. The Ministry has pledged to provide technical support and guidance to ensure the successful delivery of the event, marking a significant step forward in Rwanda's commitment to a sustainable energy future

KIGALI EDITION

6TH - 7TH AUG 2026

THE KIGALI MARRIOTT HOTEL,
RWANDA

DAY ONE : Thursday, 6th August, 2026

8:00 – 8:45 a.m.

Registration and Welcome Refreshments.
Opening

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Marriott

» Security briefing and housekeeping

8:45 – 9:00 a.m.

Opening Remarks

Stephen Kuria, Executive Chairman, Australia Kenya
Chamber of Commerce.

9:00 – 10:00 a.m.

SESSION 1

Keynote Address

Geopolitical of Energy- Developments, supply chain
realignments, Power infrastructures and changing
global energy landscape- the macroeconomic forces
influencing African energy

» Hon. Opiyo Wandayi, Cabinet Secretary, Ministry of
Energy, Kenya

Keynote/ Host Address

» Hon. Zingiro Armand
Minister of State in the Ministry of Infrastructure

Fireside Chat

» Ms. Alice Uwase- Rwanda Mines, Petroleum & Gas
Board- Rwanda
» Dr. Jonah Aiyabei, CEO
Public Service Superannuation Fund (PSSF)

Global trade and geopolitics have continued to evolve affecting investor and political perception of exploration. With the U.S. Administration focused on the promise of cheaper, reliable and secure energy and a sudden shift across much of the west from a rapid energy "transition" to more rational energy policies, will calls for increased supply support or challenge exploration in Africa? The panel aims to explore the impact of these shifts on exploration and capital investment in Africa, where E&P companies have expanded interest in frontier areas and the fundamental need for energy access remain paramount.

SESSION 2**Keynote Address**

- » Rev. Dr. Patrick Omutia. Special Secretary-Productivity

Public-sector productivity and its role in accelerating Africa's clean energy transition and sustainable economic transformation"

The Energy Paradox: Can East Africa Leapfrog to a Net-Zero Future?

As East Africa accelerates toward modernization, it faces a defining tension: how to reconcile the urgent demand for affordable, reliable energy with the global imperative to decarbonize. Are we witnessing a true green revolution, or are policy incentives merely outpacing the infrastructure?

Today, we confront the tough questions that rarely make it into press releases:

Mobility: Is EV adoption in East Africa a genuine solution for the masses, or a luxury play for the few while the grid remains fragile?

Energy: Can we realistically pivot to "clean cooking" and smart grids without leaving the most vulnerable behind?

LPG: The future of LPG in Africa, is the future of clean cooking or transportation time-bomb?

Industry: Is the "second-life battery" market a revolutionary storage answer or just a new form of toxic waste accumulation?

Realism: In a region still tethered to traditional resources, is the drive to "decarbonize" oil and gas an achievable target or a hollow policy promise?

The path to a low-carbon future is not just about technology—it is about trade-offs. Let's strip away the corporate rhetoric and debate the reality of the transition. Where do we draw the line between progress and wishful thinking?

Moderator:

- Umutoniwase Anitha- CEO & Founder- Eco Green Solutions Limited- Rwanda

Panelists:

- Josh Whale- CEO- Ampersand- Rwanda
- Tony Mutuku- CEO- Rockwill Green – Kenya
- Rwanda Energy Group (REG)
- Mr Morris Nduranu - Chairman, CPF Group

11:30 -12:30 p.m.

SESSION 3

Next-Generation Geothermal: Hybrid Systems and Industrial Applications for a Low-Carbon Economy

For decades, geothermal energy was the “forgotten” sibling of the renewables family—limited by geography and trapped in volcanic hotspots. Today, next-generation technologies like Enhanced Geothermal Systems (EGS) and superhot rock drilling promise to unlock infinite, 24/7 baseload power from anywhere beneath our feet. But as we pivot from experimental research to industrial-scale deployment, we must confront the uncomfortable realities of this “new” frontier:

The “Oil & Gas” Paradox: We are borrowing drilling techniques from the fossil fuel industry to fuel our green transition. Is this a pragmatic masterstroke of engineering, or are we simply rebranding the same extractive logic that created the climate crisis?

The Economic Chasm: Beyond the laboratory, can next-generation geothermal actually compete with the plummeting costs of solar and wind, or is this destined to remain a subsidized niche for the elite?

Industrial Integration: While the potential for heating, cooling, and industrial polygeneration is massive, who carries the financial risk when an exploratory multi-million dollar well comes up dry?

Is the massive investment in “next-gen” geothermal a strategic necessity for grid reliability?

Moderator

- Redouane Meryem, University Sidi Mohammed Ben Abdellah - Morocco

Panelists

- Caroline Kimathi – Assistant Director, Renewable Energy, Energy and Petroleum Regulatory Authority, Kenya
- Mr. Jean Pierre Muhire, CEO RENERG
- Queen Monsurat Adedamola-Awolaja, Murakwani Jebelee Advisory, Nigeria
- Rwanda Energy Group (REG)
- The Energy Development Corporation Limited (EDCL)

12.30-13.20 p.m.

Lunch and Sponsor Showcase

13:30 -14:30 p.m.

SESSION 4

The Energy Crossroads: Innovation, Extraction, or Illusion?

We are at a critical juncture in the global energy transition. We're banking on the earth's heat, betting on carbon capture, and scrambling to find the trillions needed to fund it all. But as the clock ticks toward 2030, we have to move past the glossy brochures and get honest about the risks we're taking.

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The Financing Chasm: The capital exists, but the “risk” doesn't disappear just because it's labeled green. With renewable projects struggling to secure bankable models, are we creating genuine risk-sharing partnerships, or just shifting the burden onto the next generation?

Panelists

- Eng. Elizabeth Rogo – Founder and CEO- Tsavo Oil Fields – Kenya
- Jacktone Mboya- CEO- Hung pump limited Kenya
- Youssef Mohamed- Oil and gas expert, Rwanda Mines, Petroleum and Gas Board, Rwanda

14:30 - 15:30 p.m.

SESSION 5

Breakout Rooms Discussion

Breakout Room 1

Artisanal & Critical Minerals Mining in Rwanda's Energy Transition

Theme: Responsible Mining, Critical Minerals & Local Value Addition

Context: Rwanda is emerging as a continental leader in responsible artisanal and small-scale mining (ASM) and critical mineral development for batteries, solar and electric mobility. This session explores how sustainable mining practices can fuel Africa's clean energy ambitions.

- » Rwanda's role in artisanal and small-scale mining in the clean energy era.
- » Building a sustainable value chain for critical minerals.
- » Promoting responsible extraction, processing and local beneficiation.
- » Creating lasting community value and advancing national development goals.
- » Research areas: mineralization, resource mapping, and innovation.
- » Strengthening governance for transparency, inclusivity, and sustainability.
- » Understanding the geopolitics shaping Africa's critical mineral economies.

Sustainable Mining Practices: ESG-driven operations, low-carbon mining and electrification of mines.
Innovation in Mining Tech

Moderator:

- Alice Umuhorakeye - Mining Extraction and Inspection Division Manager, Rwanda Mines, Petroleum and Gas Board, Rwanda

Panelist

- Alice Uwase- Rwanda Mines, Petroleum & Gas Board- Rwanda
- Youssef Mohamed- Oil and gas expert, Rwanda Mines, Petroleum and Gas Board, Rwanda
- Stephen Kuria, Managing Director, Australia Africa Energy and Minerals Institute, Chairman Kenya Australia Chamber of Commerce

Breakout Room 2 Renewable Energy & Circular Economy

Theme: Circularity as Capital – Embedding ESG into Investment Portfolios

For too long, “circular economy” and “ESG” have been treated as corporate PR—nice-to-have metrics relegated to the back of an annual report. But as resource scarcity bites and regulatory pressure mounts, the question is no longer whether we should be circular, but whether we can afford not to be.

We’re here to cut through the boardroom buzzwords and address the uncomfortable tension between short-term yields and long-term viability:

Circularity as Capital: Is embedding circular principles into an investment portfolio a

genuine engine for new value, or is it just a complex, costly accounting exercise that dilutes investor returns?

The Valuation Gap: If the market continues to prioritize linear “take-make-waste” growth, can circular business models ever truly compete for the big capital? Or are we stuck in a system that penalizes the very innovation we need to survive?

The Accountability Trap: How do we move from “ESG reporting” to “ESG impact”? When the data is murky and greenwashing is rampant, who holds the responsibility—and the liability—for proving that a portfolio is actually circular?

This isn’t about being “green”; it’s about the future of capital allocation.

Are we genuinely redesigning the mechanics of investment to support a circular economy, or are we just slapping an ESG sticker on a broken, linear model?

Moderator

- Muchiri Waititu, Managing Director, Aplexion Analytics Limited, Rwanda

Panelist

- Jean Bosco Mugiraneza, Director General in charge of Energy Directorate, Ministry of Infrastructure Rwanda
- Eng. Dr. Isaac Kiva, Ministry of Energy, Kenya (ADD)
- Ken Mugambi – CEO- Trinity Energy Limited, Kenya
- Dr. Jonah Aiyabei, CEO, Public Pension Service Fund, Kenya
- Charles Wanguhu- Director Enzi Ijaya Africa Initiative

15:30 – 16:30 p.m.

SESSION 6

The Deal Room: Where Vision Hits the Bottom Line

The gap between a brilliant green idea and a bankable project is often a graveyard of failed ventures. Today, we aren't just listening to pitches; we're stress-testing the future of our most critical sectors.

We have four high-stakes arenas—Renewable Energy, Circularity/Waste-to-Energy, Artisanal Mining, and Geothermal/Smart Grids. But the promise of these technologies is meaningless if the math doesn't hold up in the real world. As we open the floor to our entrepreneurs and investors, we are here to probe the uncomfortable questions that decide whether a business survives or vanishes:

The Scalability Reality Check: Does this solution actually solve a systemic problem, or is it just a high-tech “niche” play that will struggle to survive outside of a pilot project?

The Risk/Reward Paradox: Investors want impact, but they demand returns. Which of these pitches is actually offering a breakthrough, and which is just hiding behind buzzwords while ignoring the harsh economic realities of their sector?

The “True” Impact: Beyond the glossy presentation decks, how much of this is genuinely driving a low-carbon transition, and how much of it is just efficient business as usual?

This is where the rubber meets the road. To the entrepreneurs: can you prove your model is built to last? And to the investors: are you genuinely hunting for innovation, or are you just playing it safe in a rapidly changing world?

Which of these sectors do you think is currently the most over-hyped, and which one is the most dangerously undervalued by the investment community today?

Moderator

- MC

Panelist

- Dr. Ing. John Mativo- Executive Director- Laser Infrastructure & Technology solutions – Kenya
- Donatille Nkunzi, Founder and CEO, Heldis Green Solutions, Rwanda
- Prof. Emeka Oguzie, Deputy Vice Chancellor Research Development and Innovation, Federal University of Technology Owerri (FUTO), Nigeria

16.30 p.m.

Evening Tea and Networking

DAY 2: Friday 7th August ,2026

8:00 – 8:45 a.m. Registration and Welcome Refreshments.
Opening Mc

8:45 – 9:00 a.m. Welcome & Recap of Day 1

9:00 – 10:00 a.m. **SESSION 7**

Keynote Address

- » Dr. Hosea Kili is the current Group Managing Director and CEO of CPF Financial Services Ltd

Moderator

- Jean Ntazinda, Climate Concern, Rwanda

The Capital Paradox: Why Isn't Africa's Energy Transition Moving Faster?

PANELISTS

We keep hearing that Africa is the next great frontier for green energy—a continent poised to leapfrog legacy infrastructure and define the net-zero era. Yet, despite the massive influx of “climate finance” rhetoric, the gap between ambition and actual deployment remains a chasm.

Today, we move past the polished presentations to confront the uncomfortable bottlenecks in our investment systems:

The De-Risking Illusion: We talk endlessly about “blended finance” and sovereign support. But are these models actually de-risking projects, or are they just creating complex layers of bureaucracy that keep capital trapped in boardrooms while the lights stay off on the ground?

The ESG Reality Check: Is “ESG” in an African context a genuine tool for sustainable development, or has it become a comfortable compliance shield that allows investors to check boxes while ignoring the systemic hurdles that prevent large-scale impact?

On the True Cost of Capital: When we look at private equity and sovereign fund strategies, we have to ask: are these investors truly aligned with Africa's long-term climate resilience, or are they still hunting for short-term, low-risk returns in a landscape that requires a different kind of courage

- Jean Pierre Muhire, RENERG, Rwanda
- Mercy Thuo, CPF Financial Services Group, Kenya

10.00-10.30 a.m. Networking Break and Exhibition Visit

10:30 – 11:30 a.m.

SESSION 8

The Critical Nexus: Can Africa Balance Growth, Water, and Global Standards?

In regions already under the shadow of climate stress, we face an uncomfortable, three-way tug-of-war: mining needs water, energy production requires both, and the local communities who rely on these resources are increasingly at the center of the crossfire. Meanwhile, global investors are demanding strict ESG alignment—often using frameworks that feel worlds away from the reality of development on the ground in Africa.

Today, we are moving past the “checklist” approach to sustainability to address the raw, systemic friction of these competing demands:

The Nexus Crisis: As water becomes our most precious and volatile asset, how can we possibly sustain a mining and energy sector that is fundamentally resource-intensive? Are we prioritizing economic extraction at the expense of our own climate resilience?

The ESG Disconnect: Global investors want standardized metrics, but are these standards actually serving African growth, or are they creating a “compliance burden” that pushes out local innovators and hinders the very development we need?

The Path Forward: Can we build a uniquely African model for sustainability—one that satisfies global capital without sacrificing the livelihoods and natural resources of the communities at the heart of these projects?

This isn't a conversation about “how to comply.” This is a debate about “how to survive and thrive.” Are our current sustainability standards helping us build a future-proof economy, or are we just papering over the cracks of an unsustainable model?

Which is the greater threat to our progress: the physical limits of our water and energy resources, or the misalignment between local realities and the rigid expectations of global financial markets?

Can Africa Lead The Green Economy?

PANELIST

- Dr. Innocent Ndikubwimana, TEESC Ltd, Rwanda
- Dr. Mispa Fri Awasum, Founder and CEO, Awasum Consulting Group, Rwanda
- Dr. Assaph Kabaasha, CEO, WASAC Group, Rwanda

11:30 – 12:00 p.m

SESSION 9

The Human & Resource Crisis: Are We Building the Future on Shaky Ground?

As we race to pivot Africa's economy toward a low-carbon future, we are facing two critical, often ignored, bottlenecks: the physical survival of our resources and the human capacity to manage them. We are simultaneously navigating the intense Water-Energy-Mining nexus and a workforce revolution that is moving faster than our training systems can keep up.

Today, we are moving past the glossy corporate brochures to face some hard, uncomfortable truths:

The Resource Tug-of-War: In a climate-stressed world, water is the ultimate currency. When mining, energy, and community needs collide, who loses? Are our current sustainability standards and ESG metrics actually protecting these resources, or are they just providing a "green" smokescreen for continued extraction?

The Talent Chasm: We talk about "transitioning industries," but who is doing the work? As sectors evolve rapidly, our workforce planning is falling behind. Are we genuinely upskilling the next generation of African talent, or are we relying on imported expertise while our own workforce gets left in the wake of automation and rapid sector shifts?

The Alignment Trap: Are we chasing global ESG standards that were designed for a different world, or are we building a local framework that actually addresses the specific realities of African development?

This is not a session for quiet consensus. We are here to debate the friction between our economic ambitions and the physical and human realities of this transition.

PANELISTS

- Ms. Mitchele Mwambela- Chief Executive Officer- AWEIK- Kenya
- Mr. Jean Paul Ndayisabye- Chairman- RAPEP
- Winnie Pertet - Chief Executive Officer Serian Consulting Ltd

12:00 – 12:30 p.m

SESSION 10

From Garbage to Gold: Is Waste-to-Energy a Breakthrough or a Band-Aid?

Every city and industrial hub in Africa is sitting on a mountain of potential fuel: urban trash, agricultural residues, and mining tailings. The promise of “Waste-to-Energy” (WtE) is intoxicating—solve the waste crisis while generating the power we desperately need. But before we get ahead of ourselves, we need to ask: is this circularity, or is it just efficient incineration?

This panel is here to challenge the hype and look at the messy reality of the circular economy:

The Circularity Paradox: Is converting waste to energy truly a “circular” solution, or are we just creating a new dependency that incentivizes us to keep producing waste to keep the power plants running?

The Economic Reality: We hear the success stories, but what about the graveyard of failed WtE projects? Is it possible to make these models bankable and scalable without massive public subsidies, or are we chasing a pipedream?

The Mining & Ag Burden: Turning mining waste and agricultural residue into energy is technically brilliant—but who carries the environmental and health costs? Are we cleaning up our industries, or just finding a “greener” way to manage our pollution?

We aren't here for a lecture on sustainability; we are here for a debate on economics and ethics. If we truly succeed in creating a circular economy, do we eventually “waste” ourselves out of a power source? And more importantly: are these projects genuinely empowering our communities, or are they just the latest corporate experiment?

Moderator

- Mr. Munyemana Jean Pierre- Founder/ CEO - Egera Umuhinzi- Rwanda

Panelists

- Dr. Ronald Kwenya- Associate Deputy Vice Chancellor Research- Innovation & Enterprise- Rwanda
- Paulin Mburano- Managing Director and Founder- Waste Power Plant Limited- Rwanda
- WASAC Group, Rwanda

12.30- 13.20 p.m.

Lunch and Roundtable Discussions

SESSION 11**The Smart City Mirage: Progress or Privilege?**

We are constantly sold the vision of the “African Smart City”—a high-tech, electrified, and sustainable urban future. But beneath the glossy renderings of green buildings and automated grids lies a stubborn reality: Africa’s cities are growing faster than their infrastructure, and the gap between our high-tech ambitions and the lived experience of our citizens is widening.

Today, we move beyond the buzzwords of “efficiency” and “innovation” to face the difficult questions about who these smart cities are actually for:

The Accessibility Gap: We are pushing for “green” buildings and smart electrification, but are we creating a two-tier society? Are these technologies serving the general population, or are they exclusively for the affluent while the vast majority remain sidelined in informal, under-served settlements?

The Grid Dilemma: Our conventional grids are aging and unreliable, yet we talk about “smart grid integration.” Are we skipping the essential work of basic maintenance and infrastructure for the sake of shiny new tech, or can we actually leapfrog into a distributed, resilient future?

The “Luxury” Label: Is sustainable construction truly a necessity for Africa’s climate future, or is it an expensive “luxury” import that ignores the necessity of affordable, low-cost housing? How do we scale green standards without pricing out the people who need shelter most?

Data and Governance: Smart cities rely on data, but our urban systems are often fragmented and informal. Who owns the data, and can we realistically govern these complex systems without falling into the traps of surveillance and exclusionary planning?

This isn’t a conversation about the “future of tech”; it’s about the future of urban equity. Are we genuinely building cities that work for everyone, or are we just using “smart” technology to build smarter versions of the same old unequal cities?

In your opinion, what is the biggest barrier to creating inclusive smart cities in Africa: is it the lack of reliable energy infrastructure, the high cost of green building technology, or a failure of urban policy to account for informal settlements?

Panelists

- Mercy Okiro, FCI Arb Chairperson
National Construction Authority
- Eng Kazawadi Dedeki- Founder & Chairperson- TASKS AFRICA- Rwanda
- Arch. Emmanuel Nyirinkindi- Executive Secretary, Rwanda Institute of Architects, Rwanda
- Rwanda Housing Authority

14:30 – 15:30 p.m.

SESSION 12

The Agri-Energy Paradox: Feeding the Future or Fueling the Grid?

We talk about the “Water-Energy-Food Nexus” as the holy grail of sustainable development. Technologies like agrivoltaics—harvesting solar energy above the very land where we grow our crops—promise to turn a zero-sum conflict into a dual-harvest win. But beneath the optimistic diagrams of shaded crops and solar-powered irrigation, there is a complex reality we aren’t fully addressing.

Today, we move past the pilot projects to debate the systemic trade-offs of integrating energy into our food systems:

The Land-Use Tension: Is dual-use solar a genuine solution for smallholders, or are we inadvertently creating a new form of land-grabbing where energy production overshadows the primary goal of feeding communities?

The “Technological Fix” Trap: Solar irrigation is a massive leap over diesel, but are we just swapping one dependency for another? If the technology fails, who bears the burden—the tech provider or the farmer whose season is now at risk?

The Scaling Hurdle: Why, despite the clear benefits, are these models still struggling to move from small-scale demonstrations to the mainstream? Is it a failure of financing, a lack of infrastructure, or are we ignoring the cultural and structural realities of rural farming?

The Governance of Resources: When we link energy and water, we increase the complexity of the system. Can our current policy and regulatory frameworks handle the management of these hybrid systems, or are we setting ourselves up for a regulatory mess?

This isn’t a session for polite agreement. We are here to pressure-test the most promising nexus of our time. Is agrivoltaics the breakthrough that will secure Africa’s food systems, or are we just hoping that layering technology over agriculture will solve the deep-rooted issues of production, poverty, and climate vulnerability?

In your view, what is the biggest threat to the successful adoption of agri-energy: the high capital cost of the technology, or the danger of prioritizing “energy output” over the fundamental resilience of our food supply?

Moderator

- Jean Baptiste -
Chairman- Stewardship
Agribusiness
Incubation Centre
(SAIC), Rwanda

Panelists

- Dr. Oscar Magenya,
Country Director-
World Agriculture
Forum, Kenya
- Munyemana Jean
Pierre- Founder/ CEO
- Egera Umuhinzi-
Rwanda
- Andrew Gashayija, CEO,
Kilimo Trust, Rwanda

15:30 – 16:30 p.m.

SESSION 13

The Innovation Gap: Breakthrough or Just Hype?

We are surrounded by a constant stream of “game-changing” research—from advanced mining technologies and digital twins to the next generation of energy storage. Yet, when we step out of the lab and into the field, the translation of these innovations into industrial reality remains frustratingly slow. Today, we aren’t just here to review academic breakthroughs; we are here to hold them accountable. We are stripping away the jargon to confront the bridge between high-tech research and actual, on-the-ground impact:

The Digital Twin Mirage: Digital twins are marketed as the ultimate efficiency tool for mining and energy. But are they actually solving operational bottlenecks, or are we just creating expensive virtual replicas of broken, inefficient systems?

The Lab-to-Mine Divide: We see brilliant innovations in mining and energy tech, but why do so many promising prototypes die in the pilot phase? Is the industry structurally allergic to risk, or are these technologies simply not built for the harsh realities of African field conditions?

The Scalability Test: How much of this research is actually scalable for the average operator, and how much is just “prestige tech” designed for industry giants with deep pockets and little appetite for the systemic change we actually need?

Data Sovereignty: As we integrate digital twins and smart tech into our infrastructure, who really owns the insights? Are we building systems that empower local operators, or are we locking ourselves into a new dependency on proprietary, external technologies?

This is a space for critical inquiry. To the researchers: are you building solutions for a laboratory environment, or for the messy, complex reality of the industry? And to the industry leaders: are you genuinely looking for breakthroughs, or are you just looking for the next gadget to polish your “innovation” credentials?

In your opinion, which is the bigger barrier to innovation today: the lack of funding to bridge the “valley of death” between research and deployment, or a fundamental cultural resistance within the industry to adopt radical new ways of working?

Panelists

- Prof. Ogechi Adeola, Deputy Vice Chancellor for Research, Innovation, and Enterprises at the University of Kigali
- Dr. Ing. John Mativo- Executive Director- Laser Infrastructure & Technology solutions – Kenya
- Donatille Nkunzi, Founder and CEO, Heldis Green Solutions, Rwanda
- Prof. Emeka Oguzie, Deputy Vice Chancellor Research Development and Innovation, Federal University of Technology Owerri (FUTO), Nigeria

16:30 – 17.00 p.m.

SESSION 14

The Road Ahead: From Consensus to Concrete Action

We came here to debate, but we stay to deliver. Over the past few sessions, we have dismantled the myths of the “easy transition” and confronted the raw friction between our climate ambitions and the economic realities of the African market. We’ve questioned the “green” credentials of our current industry models, poked holes in our financing structures, and demanded more than just empty ESG promises.

But if we walk out of these doors and back into our silos, this was just another conference. The transition requires more than ideas; it requires a movement.

Our Shared Roadmap

The Policy Pivot: We aren’t just talking about carbon targets; we are launching the new “Pan-African Green Energy Roadmap”. This initiative isn’t a policy paper—it’s a living framework designed to de-risk investment and demand transparency from the top down.

The Action Pact: We are moving from debate to delivery.

The Network: This conversation does not end here. We are officially opening the , “Climate Transition Network”]—a permanent, digital, and physical hub for investors, entrepreneurs, and policymakers to hold one another accountable.

The Final Challenge

We’ve identified the bottlenecks—be it the water-energy-mining nexus, the talent gap, or the chasm in our financing models. Now, we have to bridge them.

Are you going to be the ones who maintain the status quo, or the ones who break it? We’ve done the questioning; now, let’s do the work.

Join us in the next chapter. Stay connected, stay critical, and let’s get to building.

Are you ready to commit? We’ll be tracking our progress through Linkend, Website and handle. What is one specific, measurable goal you are taking away from this conference to move your sector forward in the next 12 months?

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www.cleanenergyconference.com.au

CONTACTS:

Clean Energy Conference Africa Australia

Tel: +61 421800071

Email: info@cleanenergyconference.com.au
advisory@cleanenergyconference.com.au

Website: www.cleanenergyconference.com.au